

DIPOLE TYPE BY LENGTH

Compute first $\lambda=c/f$, then ratio l/λ		
l/λ	Type	Use formula
$< 1/50$	Hertzian (short)	HERTZIAN $S(R, \theta)$, $D=1.5$
$= 1/4$	Quarter-wave	ARB formula, $\pi l/\lambda = \pi/4$
$= 1/2$	Half-wave	half-wave shortcut, $D=1.64$, $R_{\text{rad}}=73\ \Omega$
$= 1$	Full-wave	ARB, $D=2.41$, $R_{\text{rad}}=199\ \Omega$
other	Arbitrary	ARB formula

If $l/\lambda < 1/50$ STOP and use Hertzian. Do NOT plug small l into the arbitrary formula — wrong shape.

HERTZIAN DIPOLE — $S(R, \theta)$

Far-field E,H phasors small $l \ll \lambda$
$\vec{E}_\theta = \frac{jI_0 k l \eta_0}{4\pi R} e^{-jkR} \sin \theta$, $\vec{H}_\phi = \vec{E}_\theta / \eta_0$
Power density $l/\lambda < 1/50$; far field
$S(R, \theta) = \frac{\eta_0 k^2 I_0^2 l^2}{32\pi^2 R^2} \sin^2 \theta = S_{\text{max}} \sin^2 \theta \text{ (W/m}^2\text{)}$
l rod length (m); I_0 peak current (A); R obs. dist. (m); θ from dipole axis; $k=2\pi/\lambda$ (rad/m); $\eta_0=120\pi \approx 377\ \Omega$.
Max @ broadside $\theta_{\text{max}} = \pi/2$; D exact $D=1.5$ (1.76 dB)
Total radiated power $P_{\text{rad}} = \frac{\eta_0 \pi}{3} (I_0 l/\lambda)^2 \text{ (W)}$

ARBITRARY-LENGTH DIPOLE — $S(\theta)$

Power density at R any l
$S(\theta) = \frac{15I_0^2}{\pi R^2} \left[\frac{\cos\left(\frac{\pi l}{\lambda} \cos \theta\right) - \cos\left(\frac{\pi l}{\lambda}\right)}{\sin \theta} \right]^2$
At $\theta = 0, \pi$: bracket is 0/0. L'Hôpital $\Rightarrow S=0$ (no axial radiation). TI-36X Pro alt: evaluate bracket at $\theta = 0.001$ rad $\rightarrow$ tiny $\rightarrow 0$.
Normalized pattern dimensionless $F(\theta) = S(\theta)/S_{\text{max}}$
Quarter-wave $l = \lambda/4$ $\pi l/\lambda = \pi/4$, $\cos(\pi/4) = \sqrt{2}/2$
$\frac{S(\theta)}{S_0} = \left[\frac{\cos\left(\frac{\pi}{4} \cos \theta\right) - \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}}{\sin \theta} \right]^2$, $S_0 = \frac{15I_0^2}{\pi R^2}$
$S_{\text{max}} = S(\pi/2) = S_0 \left(1 - \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}\right)^2 \approx 0.0858 S_0$
$D=1.64$, $R_{\text{rad}}=36.5\ \Omega$, $\theta_{\text{max}} = \pi/2$.
Half-wave $l = \lambda/2$ $\pi l/\lambda = \pi/2$, shortcut form
$S(\theta) = \frac{15I_0^2}{\pi R^2} \frac{\cos^2\left(\frac{\pi}{2} \cos \theta\right)}{\sin^2 \theta}$
$D=1.64$, $R_{\text{rad}}=73\ \Omega$, $\theta_{\text{max}} = \pi/2$.

COMMON ANGLES (deg $\leftrightarrow$ rad, trig values)

Conversion multiply by $\pi/180$ or $180/\pi$						
$\theta_{\text{rad}} = \theta_{\text{deg}} \cdot \frac{\pi}{180}$	$\theta_{\text{deg}} = \theta_{\text{rad}} \cdot \frac{180}{\pi}$					
°	rad	$\sin \theta$	$\cos \theta$	$\sin^2 \theta$	$\cos^2 \theta$	θ
0	0	0	1	0	1	
30	$\pi/6$	1/2	$\sqrt{3}/2$	1/4	3/4	
45	$\pi/4$	$\sqrt{2}/2$	$\sqrt{2}/2$	1/2	1/2	
60	$\pi/3$	$\sqrt{3}/2$	1/2	3/4	1/4	
90	$\pi/2$	1	0	1	0	
180	π	0	-1	0	1	

Antenna formulas usually take θ in rad. RAD mode on calc.

BEAM PARAMETERS — β , Ω_p , D

Step 1 — Normalize always start here
$F(\theta) = S(\theta)/S_{\text{max}}$ (unitless)
Step 2 — HPBW β half-power beamwidth, full angular width at -3 dB
Set $F(\theta) = 0.5$, solve for $\theta \rightarrow \theta_{1/2}$
$\beta = 2\theta_{1/2}$ (symmetric beams, rad or °)
Gaussian:
$F(\theta_{1/2}) = e^{-a\theta_{1/2}^2} = 0.5 \Rightarrow \theta_{1/2} = \sqrt{\ln 2/a}$
Step 3 — Pattern solid angle Ω_p units: sr
$\Omega_p = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi F(\theta) \sin \theta \, d\theta \, d\phi$
No ϕ dep.: $\Omega_p = 2\pi \int_0^\pi F(\theta) \sin \theta \, d\theta$.
TI-36X Pro: [2nd] [d/dx] for $\int \square$, set RAD mode, multiply result by 2π .
Narrow-beam Gaussian shortcut (sin $\theta \approx \theta$, $\rightarrow \infty$):
$\Omega_p \approx \frac{\pi}{a} = \frac{\pi \theta_{1/2}^2}{\ln 2}$ ($F = e^{-a\theta^2}$)
Step 4 — Directivity D
$D = \frac{4\pi}{\Omega_p}$ (unitless) $D_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} D$
Alt. with two orthogonal HPBW's: $D \approx 4\pi/(\beta_{xz}\beta_{yz})$.
Step 5 — Gain (if asked) $\xi = \text{rad. eff.}$, $0 < \xi \leq 1$
$G = \xi D$ $G_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} G$
Lossless / ideal antenna $\Rightarrow G = D$.

COMMON DIPOLE PARAMETERS

Type	l	D	D_{dB}	R_{rad} (Ω)
Isotropic	N/A	1	0	—
Hertzian	$< \lambda/50$	1.5	1.76	$80\pi^2 (l/\lambda)^2$
Half-wave	$\lambda/2$	1.64	2.15	73.2
$\lambda/4$	$\lambda/4$ (gnd)	1.64	2.15	36.6
monopole				
Full-wave	λ	2.41	3.82	199

Half-wave: $P_{\text{rad}} = 36.6 I_0^2 W$. $\lambda/4$ monopole (above ground): same patt. as half-wave but P_{rad} , R_{rad} halved.

Lossless antenna ($\xi=1$) $\Rightarrow G=D$. So in Friis, use $G_t, G_r = \text{these } D \text{ values (e.g. half-wave } G=1.64)$.

EFFECTIVE AREA A_e

Definition antenna's RX cross section (m^2)
$A_e = \frac{\lambda^2 D}{4\pi}$ (m^2)
Physical cross section wire dipole, diameter d
$A_p = l d = \frac{\lambda}{2} d$ (half-wave)
Inverse: D from A_e
$D = \frac{4\pi A_e}{\lambda^2}$ (unitless)
Hertzian special case $D=1.5$
$A_e^{\text{Hertz}} = \frac{3\lambda^2}{8\pi} \approx 0.119\lambda^2 \text{ (m}^2\text{)}$
Thin wire: $A_e \gg A_p$. Antenna captures field over $\sim \lambda$.

FRIIS TRANSMISSION FORMULA

Pwr density at RX, then RX pwr G_t, G_r linear gains; $\lambda=c/f$

$$S_r = \frac{G_t P_t}{4\pi R^2} \text{ (W/m}^2\text{)}; \quad P_r = G_t G_r \left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi R} \right)^2 P_t \text{ (W)}$$

Equivalent: $P_r = S_r A_{e,r}$.

Solve for R max range

$$R = \frac{\lambda}{4\pi} \sqrt{\frac{G_t G_r P_t}{P_r}} \text{ (m)}$$

Equivalent form using A_e recv. area form

$$P_r = \frac{G_t P_t A_{e,r}}{4\pi R^2}, \quad G_r = \frac{4\pi A_{e,r}}{\lambda^2}$$

Free-space path loss: $L_{fs} = (4\pi R/\lambda)^2$, so $P_r = G_t G_r P_t / L_{fs}$.

General form (off-axis) when patterns NOT peak-aligned

$$P_r = G_t G_r \left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi R} \right)^2 P_t F_t(\theta_t, \phi_t) F_r(\theta_r, \phi_r)$$

F_t, F_r normalized patterns at the link directions; $F=1$ when aligned.

Recipe 1. $\lambda=c/f$. 2. Convert dB gains to linear: $G=10^{G_{\text{dB}}/10}$.

3. If TX is "half-wave dipole" use $G_t=1.64$. 4. Plug into Friis.

Use linear G , not dB. Convert FIRST.

dB $\leftrightarrow$ LINEAR

Works for any power-like quantity: G gain, D directivity, P_r/P_t , SNR, etc.

$$X_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} X_{\text{lin}} \quad X_{\text{lin}} = 10^{X_{\text{dB}}/10}$$

$$\text{e.g. } D_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} D; \quad G_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} G;$$

$$SNR_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} (P_r/P_N)$$

$$\begin{array}{cc} \text{dB linear} & \text{dB linear} \\ \hline 0 & 1 \\ 3 & 2 \\ 6 & 4 \\ 7 & 5 \\ -3 & 0.5 \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{cc} 10 & 10 \\ 13 & 20 \\ 20 & 100 \\ 30 & 1000 \\ -10 & 0.1 \end{array}$$

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Memorize: $3 \text{ dB} \Leftrightarrow \times 2$, $10 \text{ dB} \Leftrightarrow \times 10$. Add dB = multiply linear.

For E-field / amplitude use 20 log not 10 log (power $\propto E^2$).

NOISE & SNR

Noise power thermal noise into matched receiver
$P_N = k_B T_{\text{sys}} B$ (W)
$k_B = 1.38 \times 10^{-23} \text{ J/K}$; T_{sys} system noise temp (K); B receiver bandwidth (Hz).
Signal-to-noise ratio
$\text{SNR} = \frac{P_{\text{rec}}}{P_N}$ (unitless) $\text{SNR}_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} \frac{P_{\text{rec}}}{P_N}$
Typical comm. link needs $\text{SNR} > 10 \text{ dB}$ for usable signal.

APERTURE ANTENNAS (horn, dish)

Directivity (any shape, uniform illum.)

$$D \approx \frac{4\pi A_p}{\lambda^2} \text{ (unitless)} \Rightarrow A_e \approx A_p$$

Directivity from beamwidths *any aperture*

$$D \approx \frac{4\pi}{\beta_{xz}\beta_{yz}} \text{ (use rad); circular: } D \approx 4\pi/\beta^2$$

HPBW and D by aperture shape *uniform illum.; β in rad*

Shape	A_p	HPBW (rad)	D (unitless)
Rect. $\ell_x \times \ell_y$		$\beta_x \approx 0.88\lambda/\ell_x$ $\beta_y \approx 0.88\lambda/\ell_y$	$D \approx 4\pi/(\beta_x\beta_y)$ $= 4\pi\ell_x\ell_y/\lambda^2$
Square ℓ	ℓ^2	$\beta \approx 0.88\lambda/\ell$	$D \approx \frac{4\pi}{\beta^2} = \frac{4\pi\ell^2}{\lambda^2}$
Circular (diam. d)	$\pi d^2/4$	$\beta \approx 1.02\lambda/d$	$D \approx \frac{4\pi}{\beta^2} = \frac{\pi^2 d^2}{\lambda^2}$

Scaling rules $D \propto A_p/\lambda^2$; $\beta \propto \lambda/\sqrt{A_p}$

Change	New D	New β	
Double ($A_p \rightarrow 2A_p$)	area	$D_{\text{new}} = 2D_{\text{old}}$	$\beta_{\text{new}} = \beta_{\text{old}}/\sqrt{2}$
Double freq ($\lambda \rightarrow \lambda/2$)		$D_{\text{new}} = 4D_{\text{old}}$	$\beta_{\text{new}} = \beta_{\text{old}}/2$

LINEAR ANTENNA ARRAY

Setup N identical elements along axis, spacing d
elem pos $z_i = id$, $i = 0, \dots, N-1$; $A_i = a_i e^{j\psi_i}$
Equal phase ($\psi_i = 0$) $\Rightarrow$ broadside beam ($\theta_{\text{max}} = \pi/2$).
Progressive phase $\psi_i = i\alpha \Rightarrow$ steered beam at $\cos \theta_{\text{max}} = -\alpha/(kd)$.
Pattern multiplication S_e = single element pattern
$S(R, \theta, \phi) = S_e(R, \theta, \phi) F_a(\theta)$
Array factor (general) $k=2\pi/\lambda$
$F_a(\theta) = \left \sum_{i=0}^{N-1} A_i e^{jkid \cos \theta} \right ^2$
Uniform $A_i = 1$, equal phase closed form
$F_a(\theta) = \frac{\sin^2(N\gamma/2)}{\sin^2(\gamma/2)}$, $\gamma = kd \cos \theta$
Peak: $F_a^{\text{max}} = N^2$ at $\gamma = 0$ (broadside, $\theta = \pi/2$). Normal-ize: $F_a^{\text{norm}} = F_a/N^2$.
HPBW (broadside, uniform) use Nd, not $(N-1)d$
$\beta \approx 0.88 \frac{\lambda}{Nd}$ (rad) $= 50.8^\circ \cdot \frac{\lambda}{Nd}$
Grating lobes appear if $d > \lambda$ (broadside). Avoid.